

Consolidated

HEAD – TALENT ACQUISITION · STRATEGIC TRANSFORMATION

Building a Talent Engine for the ₹5,000 Cr Journey

A strategic, execution-oriented plan to scale hiring to ~1,000 roles/year, cut frontline attrition, and make Talent Acquisition a true business lever — with verified global & India benchmarks.

Revenue ₹3,000 → ₹5,000 Cr

~1,000 hires/yr

Attrition 45% → <25%

TAT 50+ → ≤30 d

01 · THE CURRENT PROBLEM

One hiring engine, three breaking points

Built to grow +50–66% to ₹5,000 Cr — but the hiring engine is built for a smaller, slower company. ~1,000 hires needed this year; ~820 are high-volume frontline.

45%

OVERALL ATTRITION

55%+

FRONTLINE
ATTRITION

50+

DAY AVG TAT

₹9,000

COST PER HIRE



The leaky bucket

LEAK

45% attrition · 55%+ frontline · 11-mo tenure. ~55% of hiring just replaces churn instead of fuelling growth.



Reactive & slow

SLOW

50+ day TAT, weak forecasting, reactive pipelines. Stores open understaffed; panic hiring lowers quality.



Expensive & manual

COST

₹9,000/hire · 9–10% agency spend · partial ATS · no AI/analytics · only 20% referral hiring.

The engine was built for **steady-state replacement** at ₹3,000 Cr. The three problems feed a **vicious cycle**: high attrition forces volume → volume overwhelms a slow process → slowness forces premium agency hiring → rushed, mismatched hires churn again. Breaking the attrition link collapses the whole cycle.



HOW WE SOLVE IT

- ✓ **Attack attrition first** — every retained employee is one fewer replacement hire, shrinking both the ~1,000 number and its cost.
- ✓ **Convert ~820 frontline roles to always-on talent pools** so demand spikes are absorbed from a warm bench, not panic-hired.
- ✓ **Instrument the funnel end-to-end** (ATS + analytics) — manage by data, not gut feel.
- ✓ **Re-channel agency spend into referrals & in-house sourcing** — cut cost and raise quality at once.

Every target we're setting has already been hit

Retail churns at ~2x the economy, so <25% is best-in-class. Leaders prove the speed; an Indian Apple Premium Partner peer proves the model.



Chipotle

AI

TAT 12 → 4 days at ~10k hires/yr via conversational AI. Our hero proof-point.



7-Eleven

TAT

TAT ~10 → <5 days via AI apply/screen/schedule 24/7.



Starbucks

RETAIN

Turnover cut 65% → 49% via wages, benefits & career paths.



Unicorn Infosolutions

INDIA PEER

₹3,700 Cr+ turnover · ~100 stores + 39 service centres · 49 cities · 1,500+ staff. Almost exactly our profile.



India hiring stack

TOOLS

Vahan.ai WhatsApp AI recruiter (2–3 day fill) · Apna 22M-user network · RASCI/NAPS apprenticeships · Lenskart Academy training.



Retail turnover ~27% vs 13% economy-wide (Mercer 2025). Even Reliance Retail cut ~38,000 net jobs in FY24 while hiring hard — churn is structural; the winner stops the leak fastest. Sources: Mercer, Starbucks ESG, Paradox, RIL FY24, FranchiseIndia, RASCI — all verified.

From reactive hiring desk to talent engine

"The right people, faster, cheaper, and with staying power — a proactive, data-driven, brand-led talent engine."

The shift is from a function that **fills requisitions after they open** to one that **forecasts demand from the store-expansion plan and builds talent ahead of need** — a workforce-planning partner to Retail Ops, measured on quality and tenure, not just speed.

🎯 WHAT EACH PILLAR MEANS

- ✓ **Speed** → pipelines + AI + SLAs (TA Ops). Metric: predictable ≤30-day TAT.
- ✓ **Quality & Stickiness** → culture-fit scorecards + realistic job previews. Metric: 90-day stick rate.
- ✓ **Efficiency** → 40%+ referrals, <4% agency, AI automation. Metric: cost-per-hire ₹4,500.
- ✓ **Employer Brand** → always-on content + Apple-ecosystem prestige. Metric: inbound applications & offer-accept rate.

30 · 60 · 90 day plan

Deliberately sequenced — **you cannot scale a broken process**. Stabilise & instrument first, build the engine second, prove results third. Early visible wins buy credibility for the deeper fixes.

0–30 Diagnose & Stabilize

- Audit open reqs, TAT by stage, source-of-hire & attrition by store/tenure.
- Mandate full ATS adoption — one source of truth.
- Target top 10 bleeding stores & 20 critical roles.
- War-room for the 100 new-store buffer roles.
- Relaunch referrals with instant payouts.

31–60 Build the Engine

- Structured interview kits + culture-fit scorecards.
- Always-on talent pools for high-volume roles.
- Onboarding redesign: Day-1 readiness + 30/60/90 check-ins.
- Deploy AI screening + chatbot.
- Cut consultant contracts; shift spend to referrals.

61–90 Scale & Prove

- Early wins: TAT ~40 days on volume roles; offer-drop <20%.
- Launch employer-brand content.
- Go live with real-time KPI dashboard.
- Present committed 12-month roadmap to leadership.

Four quarters to a scalable engine

Dependency-ordered, not parallel. Each quarter has a **gate** — we don't chase the next theme until the prior quarter's enablers are live.

Q1 Foundation

→ Full ATS · structured hiring · referral engine · onboarding v2. **Gate: ATS adoption >90%.**

Q2 Speed

→ AI screening at scale · pools for top 5 roles. **Gate: TAT ≤35 days.**

Q3 Quality & Brand

→ Employer-brand campaigns · leadership playbook. **Gate: attrition <35%.**

Q4 Optimize

→ Squeeze cost & agency. **Gate: TAT ≤30, cost ₹4,500, agency <4%, referral 40%+.**

06 · ORGANIZATION

A team built for 1,000+ hires a year

Centre-of-Excellence + embedded recruiters, structured by hiring type — ~13–15 people total.

Volume / Retail

~820/yr

Frontline & service hiring.

Corporate & Enterprise

~160/yr

B2B · Edu · Corporate.

Leadership & Niche

IN-HOUSE

Exec search in-sourced.

TA Ops & Analytics

BACKBONE

ATS · AI · dashboards.

Employer Brand

PIPELINE

Always-on sourcing.

A **CoE + embedded model** gives consistency and closeness: central teams own tooling & standards; embedded recruiters sit with the business and move fast. Structuring by hiring type matters — a volume recruiter and an exec-search lead are not interchangeable.

🎯 HOW WE BUILD IT

- ✓ **Right-size to demand:** ~6–7 recruiters, 3–4 sourcers, 1 ops/analytics, 1 brand + 4 leads.
- ✓ **Real ratios:** volume recruiter $\approx$ 120–150 hires/yr · corporate $\approx$ 40–60.
- ✓ **Shift capability** to sourcing, data fluency & stakeholder management.
- ✓ **In-source leadership search** — cut agency spend, make senior hiring predictable.

07 · FASTER HIRING

Cutting TAT from 50+ to ≤30 days

First diagnose where the 50 days goes: the funnel stalls when **sourcing starts from zero** on every role and while **waiting on hiring-manager feedback**. The fix is structural — pre-build candidates and run the funnel in parallel under hard SLAs.

🎯 THE CONCRETE TAT PLAN

- ✓ **Pipeline, not posting:** pre-screened pools for ~820 volume roles → days, not weeks.
- ✓ **Parallel funnel:** screen, assess & schedule concurrently; AI screens 24/7.
- ✓ **SLA-locked stages:** HM feedback in 48h · interview-to-offer in 5 days, with escalation.
- ✓ **Instant scheduling** via chatbot for frontline; standing exec-search bench for leadership.
- ✓ **Cut offer-drop 28% → <12%** with faster cycles, transparent comp & warm engagement to Day 1.

08 · ATTRITION FRAMEWORK

45% → below 25% in 18–24 months

Attrition is **front-loaded** — ~20% of new hires leave within 45 days, ~70% of leavers within 90 days. The framework attacks all three stages where tenure is won or lost. Retention begins at the point of hire.

45%

TODAY

~35%

12 MONTHS

<25%

24 MONTHS

🎯 THE THREE-STAGE FRAMEWORK

- ✓ **A · Hire right:** culture-fit & realistic-job-preview screening + 40%+ referrals → fewer mismatched early-quitters.
- ✓ **B · Onboard right:** Day-1 readiness, buddy system, 30/60/90 check-ins, a named owner for the 90-day stick rate.
- ✓ **C · Retain right:** Advisor → Senior → Team Lead → Store Manager ladder + early-warning attrition analytics.

AI drives the speed — and halves the cost

AI absorbs the repetitive, high-volume work (sourcing, screening, scheduling, FAQs) that today eats recruiter time and agency fees, so the same team handles more hires at lower cost. Cost falls mainly as a by-product of more referrals, fewer agencies, and less rework from lower attrition.

Phased tech rollout

- **Phase 1:** full ATS + live dashboards (data spine).
- **Phase 2:** AI screening + conversational chatbot on volume funnels.
- **Phase 3:** AI sourcing + predictive attrition analytics.

COST LEVERS: ₹9,000 → ₹4,500

- ✓ **Referrals 20%→40%+** via instant-payout scheme — cheapest, stickiest channel.
- ✓ **Agency 9–10%→<4%** by in-sourcing sourcing & leadership search.
- ✓ **Lower attrition** — the largest hidden saving: every avoided replacement saves a full hire + ramp-up.

 **The flywheel:** referrals stay longer → attrition falls → fewer re-hires → recruiters focus on growth, not churn → agency budget reallocated to cheaper, stickier channels.

10 · METRICS, GOVERNANCE & RISK

How we track it — and de-risk it

KPI	NOW		TARGET
Average TAT	50+ d	→	≤30 d
Cost per hire	₹9,000	→	₹4,500
Referral hiring	20%	→	40%+
Consultant spend	9–10%	→	<4%
Offer drop	28%	→	<12%
Attrition	45%	→	<25%
90-day stick rate	base	→	90%+

Most important leading indicator: the **90-day stick rate** — it predicts attrition months before the annual number moves.

⚠ RISK → MITIGATION

- ⚠ **Competitors hiring hard** → employer brand + faster offers + referral pull.
- ⚠ **Speed vs quality** → pipelines + structured assessment.
- ⚠ **Attrition slow to fall** → front-load onboarding & first-90-day fixes.
- ⚠ **Tech adoption lag** → mandate ATS; tie to manager scorecards.
- ⚠ **Demand spikes** → 100-hire buffer + always-on pools.

 **Weekly:** open reqs vs target · TAT by stage · offers made/accepted/dropped · pipeline coverage · new-store readiness. **Monthly:** the strategic KPIs above.

11 · OUTCOMES & THE ASK

Where we land in 18–24 months

We can't hire our way to ₹5,000 Cr while 45% walks out the back door. Fix retention and speed together, and the same ~1,000 hires power real growth — faster, cheaper, built to last.

≤30 d

AVERAGE TAT

<25%

ATTRITION

₹4,500

COST PER HIRE

₹5,000 Cr

REVENUE ENABLED

Head – Talent Acquisition, Consolidated Pvt Ltd · TA as a strategic business lever · 12–24 month horizon.

